Week 5 – Windows Server Configuration

This document covers the work done on the Windows Server VM during week 5:

1. Operating System Configuration
2. Creating a User Account
3. Installing Software
4. Connecting with Remote Desktop
5. Configuring Applications

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1. Operating System Configuration

The following system settings were changed to make the server easier to administer remotely and keep it available at all times.

Category	Setting	Value	Reason
Display	Monitor turn-off timeout (`-monitor-timeout-ac`)	30 minutes	Keeps the display from going dark too quickly during admin tasks, while still saving energy when idle.
Power	Active power scheme & standby (`-setactive`)	High Performance, sleep disabled (`0`)	Prevents CPU throttling and stops the server from going to sleep, so services stay available 24/7.
Accessibility	Sticky Keys shortcut (`StickyKeys\Flags`)	Disabled	Prevents the Sticky Keys prompt from popping up when typing quickly in remote terminal sessions.

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2. Creating a User Account

A new local user was created by connecting to the server over SSH and using the `net` command:

```
ssh <admin-user>@<server-ip>
net user <username> <password> /add
```

3. Installing Software

3.1 Installing Scoop

`winget` did not work on the server, so Scoop was used as the package manager instead.

```
# Allow locally created scripts to run
Set-ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned -Scope CurrentUser

# Install Scoop (normal user)
irm get.scoop.sh | iex

# Install Scoop (Administrator PowerShell)
iex "& {$(irm get.scoop.sh)} -RunAsAdmin"
```

3.2 Installing Applications

Git is installed first because Scoop needs it to add extra buckets. The `extras` bucket contains GUI applications such as VS Code and Firefox.

```
# Install Git
scoop install git

# Add the extras bucket
scoop bucket add extras

# Install applications
scoop install vscode
scoop install firefox
scoop install 7zip
```

Software	Purpose
Git	Required by Scoop buckets
VS Code	Code / text editor
Firefox	Web browser
7-Zip	File archiver

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4. Connecting with Remote Desktop

To configure the GUI applications, `xfreerdp3` was installed on the local Linux machine and used to open a remote desktop session to the server:

```
xfreerdp3 /u:<username> /v:<server-ip> /p:<password>
```

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5. Configuring Applications

Once connected through RDP, each application was customized:

Firefox – Dark Mode

1. Open Firefox and go to `about:preferences` in the address bar.
2. Under **Website appearance**, select **Dark**.

VS Code – Font Size

1. Press `Ctrl + ,` to open **Settings**.
2. Search for **Font Size** and set it to `12`.

7-Zip – Memory Limit

1. Open 7-Zip File Manager and go to **Tools** → **Options** → **Settings**.
2. Increase the memory usage limit from **4 GB** to **8 GB**.